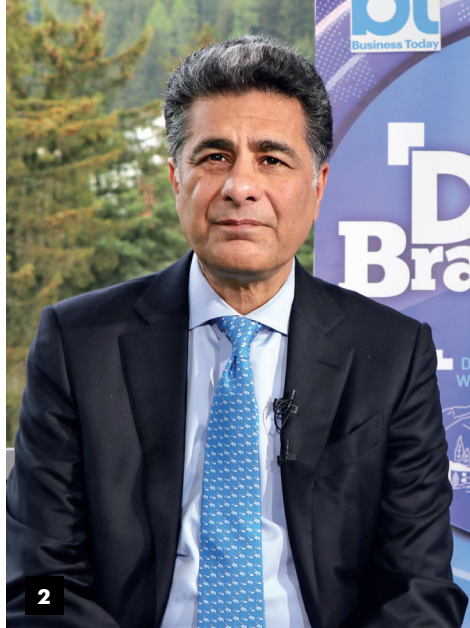




betting their money on India. “We just did a study, where 75 per cent of the 2,000 chief executives interviewed said they were looking to invest in India, but there was a disconnect in perception as to what has changed in terms of ease of doing business, particularly with Asian investors, that needs to be addressed,” Renjen revealed.

Industry veteran Ajit Gulabchand, Chairman and Managing Director of Hindustan Construction Company and a long-time Davos visitor, points out that it is not

the first time that the India story has been marketed aggressively at Davos. “It was at its peak when we had the India Everywhere campaign that Nandan Nilekani launched at Davos,” he said. That 2006 brand campaign reportedly cost over \$4 million and is described as the ‘great Indian hope trick’ in an article in the business journal of the Wharton School.

“The world desires that India succeeds. Having faced supply chain disruption, countries are thinking about how to minimise the disruption and not put all eggs in one bas-

ket,” says Gulabchand, adding that India needs to prune excessive regulation as it hampers business.

On her part, Gita Gopinath, First Deputy Managing Director of the International Monetary Fund, says, “This is a moment to seize for India and capitalise on the opportunity,” as the cost of producing goods has gone up in China. “The important thing to be a big part of the global supply chain is to produce at a very big scale and that has always been a challenge for the Indian economy. Most Indian firms are small in size